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"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, humid, partly cloudy, high 71. **Tonight,** showers, mainly north and west, low 64. **Tomorrow,** very warm, humid, some clouds mixed in, high 79. Weather map is on Page B12.

VOL. CLXXVI .... No. 61,036 © 2026 The New York Times Company TUESDAY, OCTOBER 13, 2026 Prices in Canada may be higher $4.00



MAX WHITTAKER FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A.I. on Lookout for Wildfires
California is installing cameras in some of its highest, craggiest sites to get an early warning of a potentially deadly blaze. Page A10.

Deal on Diesel Jolts U.S. Ties With Ukraine

Biggest Crisis Since Spat in Oval Office in 2025

This article is by ***Anton Troianovski, Jeanna Smialek, Andrew E. Kramer*** *and* ***Steven Erlanger****.*

President Trump's new diplomatic crisis over Ukraine first erupted at Steve Witkoff's exclusive golf club outside Miami on Friday.

Senior Ukrainian and European officials had traveled to the club, Shell Bay, for talks with Mr. Trump's peace envoys, Mr. Witkoff and Jared Kushner. They had planned to discuss updated proposals to end the war in Ukraine ahead of another trip to Russia by Mr. Witkoff and Mr. Kushner.

But Mr. Witkoff and Mr. Kushner soon made an announcement that stunned the visitors and much of the world when the news became public shortly thereafter. The United States, the Americans said, would suspend sanctions on Russian diesel fuel. The Americans added a firm request from Mr. Trump: that Ukraine stop attacking Russian oil refineries.

One of the Ukrainians asked what they would get in return.

The Americans responded that the United States was doing a lot for Ukraine already, according to three people familiar with the meeting, and should not have to make a trade for Ukraine to stop its refinery attacks. The Americans then mentioned U.S. intelligence assistance, considered vital to the Ukrainian war effort.

Some in the room heard that as a veiled threat, according to two of the people. A U.S. official, speaking on condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive diplomacy, denied any suggestion of a threat to withhold such support. But the official also said that Mr. Trump had grown so angry with Ukraine that it was hard to say what he might do.

Now, the dispute has ballooned into the biggest crisis between Washington and Kyiv since the Oval Office blowup with Ukraine's president last year. The future of U.S. support for Ukraine again appears to be hanging in the balance. The escalating back-and-forth showed how Mr. Trump's efforts to bring down energy prices before next month's midterm elections have threatened to destabilize the fragile Ukraine talks.

Mr. Witkoff and Mr. Kushner are now indicating that they have put their expected trip to Russia on hold until President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine mends fences with Mr. Trump, two people familiar with the talks said.

To the Ukrainians and their European supporters, the attacks on Russia's fuel refineries are Kyiv's most effective way to respond to

Continued on Page A5

MUSK'S SPENDING ON THE MIDTERMS HITS $366 MILLION

G.O.P. RESCUE MISSION

Largest Known Donor — a Funding Advantage for Republicans

By THEODORE SCHLEIFER

WASHINGTON — Elon Musk has quietly funneled more than $276 million into Republican groups and his super PAC since the start of July, building a huge turnout operation to help the party battle headwinds in the midterm elections.

The staggering amount of money makes Mr. Musk, the richest person in the world, by far the largest known donor in the midterms. Representatives for Mr. Musk supplied the previously unreported figures on his political giving to The New York Times before a federal filing deadline on Thursday.

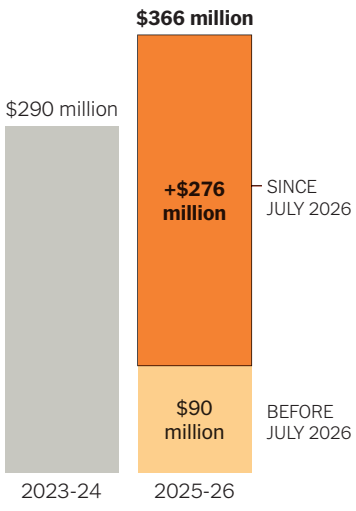
In an effort to save Republicans' Senate majority, he gave a total of $158 million this summer to the Senate Leadership Fund, the main super PAC backing the party's candidates for the chamber, according to his team. In sum, that is one of the largest political donations in American history, and more than the group's Democratic rival raised from all of its donors that quarter.

Mr. Musk has also built a major Republican turnout operation through a super PAC he founded in 2024, America PAC. He donated over $76 million this summer to the group, which in turn spent that much on building a sprawling can-

Continued on Page A14

Elon Musk's Campaign Contributions

Mr. Musk has already given far more money to federal committees during this election cycle than in 2024.



Sources: Federal Election Commission filings (prior contributions); representatives for Mr. Musk (most recent contributions).

JILLIAN VORDICK/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Dozens Killed As Bombs Hit Sudan Miners

This article is by ***Abdalrahman Altayeb, Declan Walsh*** *and* ***Malachy Browne****.*

KASSALA, Sudan — Dozens of gold workers in northern Sudan were killed over the weekend after warplanes bombed an open-air mine near the Egyptian border, according to Sudanese rights groups, graphic video and witnesses interviewed by The New York Times.

Footage from the aftermath of the bombing showed badly mutilated bodies of young men scattered amid sacks of mineral ore at a remote site in Red Sea State, roughly 25 miles from Sudan's border with Egypt.

"We were overcome with terror," said Saif Eldin Adam, 26, a university student who worked at the mine for the past three months. Mr. Adam said he helped rescue the wounded and recover the dead after the strikes.

"There are no words for what we saw," he said.

Emergency Lawyers, a rights group, estimated the death toll at 72. Two witnesses said it was at least 65, with an additional 120 or more wounded.

The attack occurred hundreds of miles from the front lines of Sudan's devastating civil war. Sudanese news media reports and several rights groups blamed Egypt for the strike. In June, miners accused Egyptian forces of carrying out a drone attack on another gold mine in the region.

Sudan mines billions of dollars' worth of gold every year, with the two warring sides using the profits to bankroll their fight. Sudan's military has bombed mines con-

Continued on Page A8

Taliban Leveraging European Fears on Migrants

Kabul Offers Deals on Deportation to Gain More Acceptance

By ELIAN PELTIER and JIM TANKERSLEY

Governments in Europe have long shunned the Taliban, primarily because of their severe restrictions on women and girls. But under pressure to appear tougher on migration, the Europeans are deporting refugees to Afghanistan and in recent months have been negotiating with the Taliban government to make more expulsions possible.

At a meeting in Brussels in late June, more than 20 European officials met with five Taliban representatives to discuss deportations, breaking a taboo against holding talks with the group in the European Union.

The Europeans never mentioned human rights abuses committed by the Taliban, according to three participants and three officials briefed on the meeting.

The details of the meeting are being reported here for the first time. This article is based on information from the German foreign ministry, along with interviews with seven other diplomats, including five representing European countries, and two Afghan government officials, all of whom requested anonymity to discuss sensitive negotiations.

Afghanistan has for years been one of the main sources of unauthorized migrants to Europe, and the European governments in talks with the Taliban insist they are solely technical and limited to expulsions. But many human rights groups say that the deportation drive ignores the risks faced by Afghans back home.

"The European Union cannot credibly condemn the Taliban's systematic repression while engaging with them to deport Afghans into the very abuses they claim to oppose," said Fereshta Abbasi, the Afghanistan researcher at Human Rights Watch.

Full diplomatic recognition of the Taliban remains a taboo. Russia is the only country in the world to formally recognize the group.

But the Taliban see sustained

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TOMAS MUNITA FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Kabul streets were filled in August as the Taliban celebrated their fifth year of ruling Afghanistan.

Home of Representative Omar Is Searched by an Arm of ICE

This article is by ***Devlin Barrett, Hamed Aleaziz, Ernesto Londoño*** *and* ***Alan Feuer****.*

Federal agents executed a search warrant at the home of Representative Ilhan Omar of Minnesota on Monday, according to three people briefed on the matter, the kind of investigative step the Justice Department has long shied away from so close to an election.

The court-approved search of her Washington-area home comes after Department of Homeland Security officials said in recent months that they were investigating Ms. Omar, a Democrat, over her family's immigration paperwork.

More recently, some federal investigators have also sought to examine other issues, such as Ms. Omar's finances, campaign funds and interactions with a foreign citizen, as The New York Times previously reported.

The three people who described the execution of the search warrant spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to discuss it.

The search warrant, executed 22 days before Election Day, lists a series of potential immigration crimes under investigation, including false statements and fraud in immigration paperwork, as well as a general conspiracy charge, according to a person familiar with the document.

The search warrant was the subject of significant back-and-forth between prosecutors and the

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To Ease Her Grief, She Took 30 New Friends Out to the Ballgame

Season of Shared Hope for Mother in Seattle

By TIM ARANGO

SEATTLE — On the last Sunday afternoon of September, Rhenda Strub was bundled up against the autumn chill for one final day at the ballpark, eating Cracker Jack and sweet and spicy pickles.

Another baseball season was ending as it often does in Seattle: abruptly and too soon. There would be no postseason for the Mariners, the only franchise never to have appeared in a World Series.

A. Bartlett Giamatti, a literary scholar who served as commissioner of Major League Baseball for five months until he died unexpectedly in 1989, wrote that baseball is "designed to break your heart," because it "leaves you to face the fall all alone."

Yet this season, Ms. Strub, 71, found that the opposite was also true: Baseball can help heal a broken heart.

After she lost her 27-year-old son, Wyatt, to muscular dystrophy three years ago, she retreated to his room and spent countless hours alone quilting and watching baseball games on television.

The constancy of baseball helped to structure her days, but the loneliness only added to her grief.

So at the beginning of this season, Ms. Strub bought two season tickets to the Mariners in Section 120, on the first-base side, thinking she would regularly go with her loved ones to T-Mobile Park. But her husband doesn't like

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Recasting Mariupol Attack
A Russian documentary claims that Ukraine, not Russia, was behind the deadly bombing of a theater. PAGE A4

Threat to Global Energy Order
The strikes on Saudi Arabia underscore a period of insecurity in the energy industry in the Middle East. PAGE A5

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Threats have altered the lives of an Arizona lawmaker, her family, friends and neighbors. They have even transformed her policymaking. PAGE A9

Public Divided on Executions
A botched lethal injection and a planned livestreamed firing squad renewed the debate and the divisions. PAGE A16

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Novelist Lived His Thrillers
Jeffrey Archer, 86, wrote on themes he knew well: ambition, self-promotion, misbehavior and scandal. PAGE B10



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U.S. Nears Solar Breakthrough
Manufacturers say they're close on a panel that's able to handle harsh conditions. Above, simulating hail. PAGE B1

Nobel for Booms and Busts
Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford were honored for their insights on dealing with economic shocks. PAGE B1

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From Yukon to Maple Leafs
Gavin McKenna, who was the No. 1 N.H.L. draft pick, had a rarely made journey that was shaped by his northern Canadian roots. PAGE B6

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Diverging Biological Clocks
Two sisters thought new technology might explain why their health differed so sharply. Instead, it stirred up feelings that weren't easily quantified. PAGE D4

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Michelle Cottle PAGE A18



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Find Him in the Funny Pages
The comedy writer Tom Gammill stars in a play about the author of the "Nancy" comic strip. Above, Gammill holding Nancy and Sluggo, her pal. PAGE C1

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